

The café in the city centre is slightly buzz with activity. She orders herself a cup of cinnamon latte. The students chatter, the housewives gossip and there is pop music playing softly in the background. Before she has paid for her coffee, she has made enough money to pay for a thousand more with the click of the mouse. Welcome to the modern day virtual marketplace where everything is a possibility.

Sounds familiar? This is a vastly commonplace setting for several urban businesses. A large populace of people have resorted to operating home run businesses and hence deviating from the traditional organic bazaar set up. Our dear “couch surfers” today have figured a way to monetise home time whilst providing comforts of easy shopping to consumers.

Historically, the place of business has been a constant location with vendors hawking their wares to a stream of prospective buyers. However, with the onset of the technological era, selling has become easier, faster and a proven supply mechanism to cope with the level of demands has been established. Today, both buyers and sellers can accomplish this from the comfort of their homes without investing time and effort in the transactions.

Show me the money, honey

Investments and things to consider at the get go

In almost an oxymoronic inclined statement, the expenditure to put a roof over your head becomes the means to help you create an income. That spare bedroom can now be converted into your own private office. This removes all overhead costs of investing money in space and allied expenses that come from maintaining the space (electric and water supply, operating licenses etc.). Not to mention the time, money and effort saved from the lack of a commute. With the rising real estate (even leasing) and fuel prices this sounds like a good deal, doesn't it?

Setting up a shop may help your customers understand your branding and your style. A good example of this would be a souvenir shop where setting up a theme (quirky, art deco, vintage, new age, etc.) in a tangible setting makes it more believable. Do you now see how that grandfather clock sits with your tiffany lamp in your new swanky two thousand square feet living room? However, the big “BUT” in this is, there is a sizable amount of money to be invested in making this dream come true. Time taken to realize this dream is also a big investment and commitment to make. Are you willing to do that to be able to give your customer an experience of what YOU think their shopping experience should be? Is it worth the effort-Is